

Ending Well

Twelve weeks, on your own. This is where you tell the men you will walk with where you started, what changed, what God did, and what you hope for — in your own words, one line at a time. Each line starts for you; you finish it.

This sheet carries the same questions as the page, for working away from a screen. When you are ready, type your lines into Ending Well in Week 12 so it is saved to your page.

Part 1 of 6 — The Doorway

Week 12 says “look for, pray for, and actively seek relationship and community with other men.” This is written to them, before you have met them.

Twelve weeks. Say the first true word. The row of words is there if you need it. Then say why, in a few words.

Finish the line. For example: To the men I will walk with, I am tired and hopeful. You haven't heard any of this yet. Here it is.

Words to choose from: thankful · grateful · sad · still struggling with · hopeful

To the men I will walk with, I am ...

What will they see when they meet you? One picture.

Finish the line. For example: What you will see in me is a man who did twelve weeks of this with nobody watching.

What you will see in me is ...

Part 2 of 6 — Where I started

Week 1 was The Enemy Knows You — “he’s a person who has studied you your whole life.” Where were you when you read that? A picture a man could see, not a label.

Finish the line. For example: When I started, I was sitting in the truck in the driveway, not ready to go in the house.

When I started, I was ...

The sentence you were living on. Short.

Finish the line. For example: What I told myself was that I had it handled.

What I told myself was ...

The part no one could see from outside.

Finish the line. For example: What nobody knew was how long it had been going on.

What nobody knew was ...

Part 3 of 6 — What changed

Not twelve weeks. What is different in you, in three places: body, soul, spirit.

Week 1 called it your Sphere of Influence: “any sound, sight, smell, or touch, you control.” And: “The enemy has had free rein inside your SOI, and he’s been bringing his trash in with him.” What was coming in?

Finish the line. For example: What came in through my eyes and ears was a screen at midnight and voices telling me I was the only one.

What came in through my eyes and ears was ...

Same sphere, your hands on the gate now. What do you let in?

Finish the line. For example: What I take in now is a walk before the house wakes up and a chapter of John read out loud.

What I take in now is ...

Be transformed by the renewal of your mind — Romans 12:2

A word, a relationship, a habit of thought. What is being made new?

Finish the line. For example: What is being renewed in me is the word “father” — it used to mean absence.

What is being renewed in me is ...

So now faith, hope, and love abide, these three — 1 Corinthians 13:13

Spirit is relationship. Which one grew, and what does it look like?

Finish the line. For example: Between me and God, what is growing is hope. I expect him to show up now.

Words to choose from: faith · hope · love

Between me and God, what is growing is ...

Part 4 of 6 — What God did

I will turn their mourning into joy; I will comfort them, and give them gladness for sorrow. — Jeremiah 31:13

If it is still quiet and the struggle is still here, say that. It is not failure. This takes years, not weeks, and God's answer may be as small as a room with men in it.

What did you ask God for at the start? Say it the way you said it then. Not every ask is answered yet.

Finish the line. For example: I asked him for it to stop.

I asked him for ...

One true sentence. For some men it is this: there are men out there willing to walk with me, and I am going to find them. That is God offering relationship.

Finish the line. For example: What God did was keep me at it for twelve weeks with nobody watching.

What God did was ...

Years, not weeks. One step you can take this month.

Finish the line. For example: The small step I can grow by is finding one man and telling him I did this.

The small step I can grow by is ...

Part 5 of 6 — My hope for the future

Week 12 says “orientation was always the trailhead, not the destination.” A year down the trail — what do you want to be true?

Finish the line. For example: My hope for the future is to be a man my kids can tell the truth to.

My hope for the future is ...

The course is done. What will you need from the men you find?

Finish the line. For example: What I will ask of you is to ask me the question, even when I say I'm fine.

What I will ask of you is ...

Say it plainly and own it. Both are honorable.

Finish the line. For example: Going forward, I will find a group of men and tell them what I wrote here.

Words to choose from: find men · keep walking on my own for now

Going forward, I will ...

Week 12: “The days are not the achievement. Whatever you did that made the days is the achievement. Find it, name it out loud in the room, and do it again.” Pick one, or write your own.

Finish the line. For example: When the gaps get longer, I will remember by reading this again on the first of the month.

Words to choose from: reading this again · a text to one man · coffee with one man · a meeting

When the gaps get longer, I will remember by ...

Part 6 of 6 — Set a stone

A stone is what you set so you can find the way again. Choose yours: one of your own lines above, or the words you walk by.

Or your own words.

Your own words. For example: Do the next right thing.

Or tap one of your own lines from What God did when you type this into the page.

